

APA Capstone Format Mechanics Guide

This document is the official format mechanics guide for PaperPilot fixture testing. Upload it under Format Mechanics so PaperPilot can extract labeled rules into Format Fields. Review every extracted value, then save the profile before analyzing manuscripts.

The requirements below follow an APA-style undergraduate thesis layout: Letter paper, Times New Roman, double spacing, one-inch margins, and half-inch first-line indentation.

Paper

Paper size: 8.5 x 11 (Letter)

Orientation: Portrait

Paper substance / weight: 20

Use standard Letter paper only. Do not submit A4 or Legal unless the department revises this guide.

Spacing and indentation

Line spacing: 2.0

First-line indentation: 0.5 inch

Body text must be double spaced throughout. Do not use single spacing or 1.5 spacing for body paragraphs. Indent the first line of every body paragraph by 0.5 inch (one tab).

Margins (inches)

Top margin: 1

Bottom margin: 1

Left margin: 1

Right margin: 1

Gutter: 0

Header: 0.5

Footer: 0.5

Maintain one-inch margins on all sides of every page. Header and footer clearances are one-half inch. Do not use a binding gutter unless your department issues a separate instruction.

Font

Font type: Times New Roman

Font color: Black/Automatic

Heading 1 size: 16 pt

Heading 2 size: 14 pt

Heading 3 and body content size: 12 pt

All body text must use Times New Roman at 12 pt. Do not substitute Arial, Calibri, or other typefaces. Chapter titles use Heading 1 at 16 pt. Section titles use Heading 2 at 14 pt.

Alignment

Body text alignment: left

Keep body paragraphs left-aligned (flush left). Centered text is allowed only for the manuscript title and approved title-page lines. Do not fully justify body text unless the department amends this guide.

Pagination

Page number position: Top right

First page of each chapter: No page number shown

Place Arabic page numbers at the top right of the page. Hide the page number on the first page of each chapter. Continue consecutive numbering across chapters.

Page breaks

Insert a page break only when starting a new chapter.

Start every new chapter on a fresh page. Do not insert decorative blank pages between sections unless required by a separate department checklist.

Tables

Table naming: Table <name> above a "TABLE TITLE" caption.

Place the table identifier and title above the table. Keep table text in Times New Roman. Avoid splitting a table across pages when it fits on a single page.

Figures

Figure naming: Figure <number>: Figure Title in bold/underlined below the figure.

Place figure captions below the figure. Number figures sequentially through the manuscript. Reference each figure in the body text before it appears.

Citation format

Citation style: APA

Use APA citation format for in-text citations and the reference list. Ensure author-date citations match the reference entries exactly.

Compliance checklist for authors

- Confirm paper size is Letter (8.5 x 11) and orientation is Portrait.
- Confirm all margins are 1 inch and header/footer clearances are 0.5 inch.
- Confirm body font is Times New Roman 12 pt with black automatic color.
- Confirm line spacing is double (2.0) and first-line indent is 0.5 inch.
- Confirm body paragraphs are left-aligned, not centered or justified.

- Confirm page numbers appear top right and chapter openers hide the number.
- Confirm tables and figures follow the naming patterns above.
- Confirm citations follow APA before submitting for PaperPilot analysis.

End of format mechanics guide. After uploading this file in PaperPilot, review Format Fields and save the profile. Then upload a manuscript and run Analyze using this saved mechanics profile.